

The different colors made it easy for the crowd to work out who was who as the chariots charged around the track.

The horses came from Spain, Greece, and North Africa, and some became as well-known as the charioteers themselves. By today's standards, Roman horses were larger than a pony but smaller than a full-sized modern horse. Horses usually

pulled chariots in teams of two or four, harnessed side by side, but sometimes up to 10 were used.

On your marks, get set, go!

A race meeting began with a parade. It was a chance for the public to view the charioteers and bet on who they thought would win. On a signal from the race starter, the gates of

